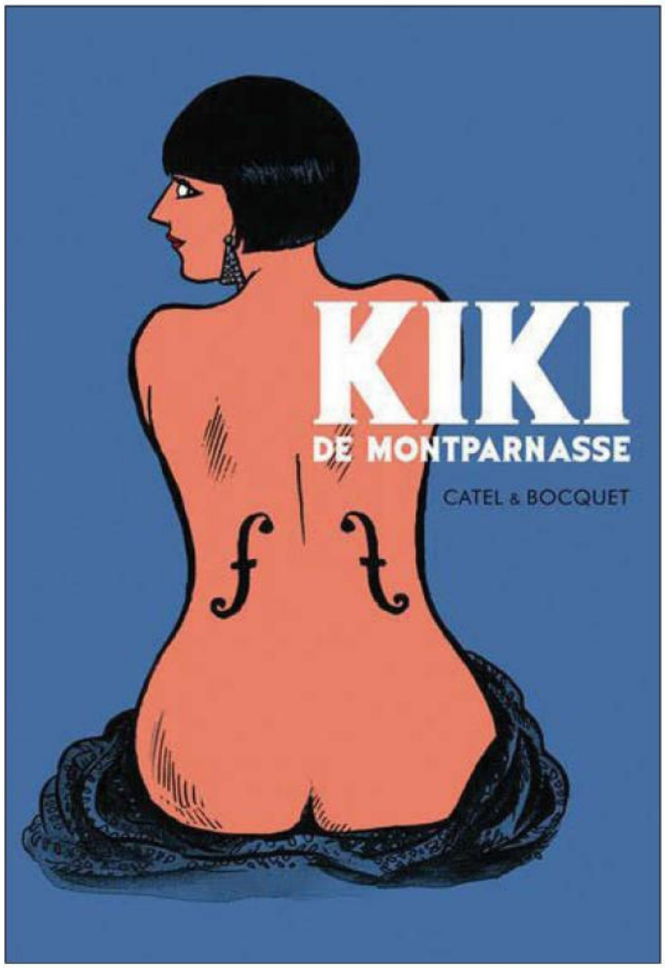
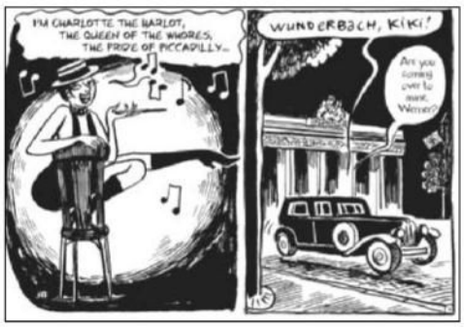
KIKI DE MONTPARNASSE

Details **Originally published** Kiki de Montparnasse (2007) **Publisher** Casterman, SelfMadeHero
Writer José-Louis Bocquet **Artist** Catel **Collected in** Kiki de Montparnasse **Available digitally** Sequential

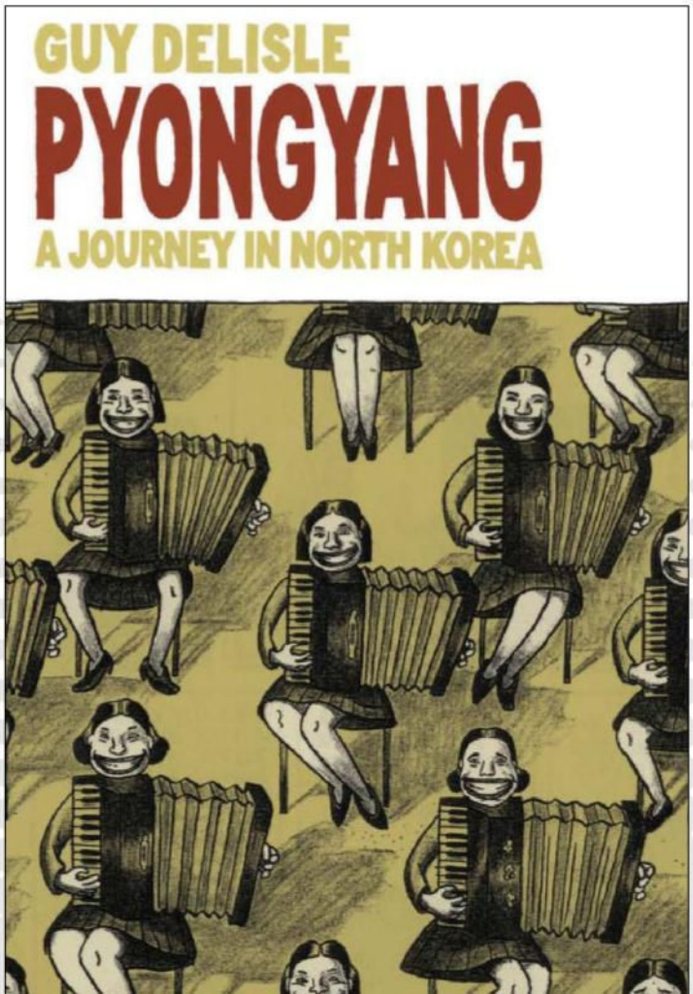


Kiki de Montparnasse, born Alice Prin, moved far beyond her humble illegitimate French country beginnings to become one of the most famous bohemian models of the Jazz age. Muse to many of the period's greatest artists and partner of the famous photographer Man Ray (whose photo of Kiki is the inspiration for the cover), Kiki's ambition and independence made her one of the first emancipated women of the era.

While Kiki's biography is factually fascinating, the graphic medium is perfect for drawing out the true dazzling nature of the woman herself and the impact she had on the artistic set she surrounded herself with. Using charisma and sex to advance herself in life, Kiki wastes no time wallowing in shame or guilt, but throws herself full force into enjoying life on her own terms – a remarkable feat at the time.



That same stubbornness and hedonistic lifestyle is not without its tragedies, but given Kiki's own memoirs were banned in the US upon release in 1929, this is an engaging, scandalous and bawdy treat.



PYONGYANG: A JOURNEY IN NORTH KOREA (2004)

Details **Originally published** Pyongyang (2004) **Publisher** Drawn and Quarterly **Writer** Guy Delisle
Artist Guy Delisle **Collected in** Pyongyang **Available digitally** N/A

An incidental record of life in the Hermit Kingdom, French-Canadian cartoonist Guy Delisle found himself spending two months working in Kim Jong-Il's insular and secretive North Korea, liaising between his own company and the Korean animation studio they outsourced some of the work too.

Merging history and politics with Bill Bryson-esque observations on life and culture and very mundane frustrations on trying to conduct business in the world's last bastion of glassy-eyed Soviet-style socialism, *Pyongyang* was the first of Delisle's idiosyncratic and insightful graphic travelogues translated into English.



Despite being followed by similar accounts of life in Jerusalem and Burma, *Pyongyang* is truly special. As a snapshot of world few Westerners get to see, no record like it exists in any medium, yet alone in comics.